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United States Patent	12416238
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
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Shaft for a turbomachine

Abstract

A turbomachine including a turbine rotor, a compressor rotor, and a shaft, and at least one balance weight assembly connected to the shaft. The shaft drivingly connects the turbine rotor with the compressor rotor to rotate the compressor rotor about a rotational axis when the turbine rotor rotates about the rotational axis. The at least one balance weight assembly including a first chamber, at least one additional chamber, and a balance weight movable between the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber.

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Appl. No.: 18/734374

Filed: June 05, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240318556 A1	Sep. 26, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17929554 20220902 US 12006833 child-doc US 18734374

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: F01D5/02 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **F01D5/027** (20130101); F05D2220/323 (20130101); F05D2240/60 (20130101);
F05D2260/96 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: F01D (5/027); F05D (2220/323); F05D (2240/60); F05D (2260/96); F02K (3/06)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/929,554 filed on Sep. 2, 2022, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to shafts used for turbomachines, particularly, those used in gas turbine engines for aircraft.

BACKGROUND

(2) Turbomachines, particularly, gas turbine engines used in aircraft include at least one shaft connecting, for example, turbine rotors with compressor rotors. During operation, these shafts heat up, and upon shutdown the shafts begin to cool. The cooling of the shaft may be uneven. Uneven cooling of the rotor results in a top portion of the shaft being longer than a bottom portion of the shaft, and with the shaft being supported by bearings, this length difference creates a bow in the shaft. Depending upon the magnitude of the bow in the shaft, the bow may limit the ability to restart the engine.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Features and advantages of the present disclosure will be apparent from the following description of various exemplary embodiments, as illustrated in the accompanying drawings, wherein like reference numbers generally indicate identical, functionally similar, and/or structurally similar elements.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a schematic perspective view of an aircraft having gas turbine engines that may implement various embodiments of the present disclosure.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a schematic, cross-sectional view, taken along line 2-2 in FIG. 1, of one of the gas turbine engines of the aircraft shown in FIG. 1.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a schematic, detail cross-sectional view, showing detail 3 in FIG. 2, of a shaft the gas turbine engine shown in FIG. 2, having a bow mitigation system according to an embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a cross-sectional view of the shaft, taken along line 4-4 in FIG. 3, showing the bow mitigation system in a shutdown condition.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view of the shaft, taken along line 4-4 in FIG. 3, showing the bow mitigation system in an operating condition.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a graph showing the magnitude of bowing in the shaft as a function of motoring time.
- (8) FIG. 7 shows a bow mitigation system according to another embodiment.
- (9) FIG. 8 is a flow chart showing operation of the bow mitigation system shown in FIG. 7.
- (10) FIG. 9 is a schematic cross-sectional view of a shaft of a gas turbine engine having a bow mitigation system according to a further embodiment.
- (11) FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view of the shaft, taken along line 10-10 in FIG. 9, showing the bow mitigation system in a shutdown condition.
- (12) FIG. 11 is a cross-sectional view of the shaft, taken along line 10-10 in FIG. 9, showing the bow mitigation system in an operating condition.
- (13) FIG. 12 shows a baffle of the bow mitigation system shown in FIGS. 9 to 11.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (14) Features, advantages, and embodiments of the present disclosure are set forth or apparent from a consideration of the following detailed description, drawings, and claims. Moreover, the following detailed descriptions are exemplary and intended to provide further explanation without limiting the scope of the disclosure as claimed.
- (15) Various embodiments are discussed in detail below. While specific embodiments are discussed, this is done for illustration purposes only. A person skilled in the relevant art will recognize that other components and configurations may be used without departing from the spirit and the scope of the present disclosure.
- (16) As may be used herein, the terms “first,” “second,” and “third” may be used interchangeably to distinguish one component from another and are not intended to signify location or importance of the individual components.
- (17) The terms “forward” and “aft” refer to relative positions within a gas turbine engine or vehicle, and refer to the normal operational attitude of the gas turbine engine or vehicle. For

example, with regard to a gas turbine engine, forward refers to a position closer to an engine inlet, and aft refers to a position closer to an engine nozzle or an exhaust.

(18) The terms “upstream” and “downstream” refer to the relative direction with respect to fluid flow in a fluid pathway. For example, “upstream” refers to the direction from which the fluid flows, and “downstream” refers to the direction to which the fluid flows.

(19) The terms “directly upstream” or “directly downstream,” as may be used herein, describe the relative placement of components in a fluid pathway, refer to components that are placed next to each other in the fluid pathway without any intervening components between them other than an appropriate fluid coupling, such as a pipe, a tube, a valve, or the like, to fluidly couple the components. Such components may be spaced apart from each other with intervening components that are not in the fluid pathway.

(20) The terms “coupled,” “fixed,” “attached,” “connected,” and the like, refer to both direct coupling, fixing, attaching, or connecting, as well as indirect coupling, fixing, attaching, or connecting through one or more intermediate components or features, unless otherwise specified herein.

(21) The singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

(22) Here and throughout the specification and claims, range limitations are combined and interchanged. Such ranges are identified and include all the sub-ranges contained therein unless context or language indicates otherwise. For example, all ranges disclosed herein are inclusive of the endpoints, and the endpoints are independently combinable with each other.

(23) As noted above, turbomachines, particularly, gas turbine engines used in aircraft include at least one shaft connecting, for example, turbines rotors with compressor rotors. During operation, these shafts heat up, and upon shutdown the shafts begin to cool. The cooling of the shaft may be uneven, and uneven cooling of the rotor results in a top portion of the shaft being longer than a bottom portion of the shaft. With the shaft being supported (constrained) by bearings, this length difference creates a bow in the shaft. Bowing of the shaft causes the center of gravity of the shaft to move off of the rotational axis of the shaft, and if rotated under such conditions, the bowed shaft causes vibration. Some amount of vibration may be acceptable when the engine is started (rotated), but greater amounts of bowing result in a greater shift of the center of gravity and vibrations that are not acceptable.

(24) To restart a turbomachine with a shaft that has bowed to levels causing unacceptable vibrations, the turbomachine is “motored” for a period of time. Motoring is a process where the turbomachine is rotated by a separate power source and the turbomachine does not operate on the power of the turbomachines. Fuel is not supplied to the combustor of the turbomachine in this process, and this process is sometimes referred to as dry motoring. A separate motor, such as a starter, is used to rotate the shaft of the turbomachine at a relatively slow speed compared to normal operating speeds of the turbomachine. As the turbomachine is motored, the temperature of the shaft is more evenly distributed, reducing the bow. The turbomachine may be motored until the bow is reduced to levels that produce acceptable levels of vibration. The motoring time is directly proportional to the amount of bow in the shaft and the greater the amount of bow, the greater time amount of motoring time is required.

(25) The embodiments discussed herein include shaft bow mitigation systems that utilize balance weights to counteract the center of gravity shift during bowing. The balance weights are connected to the shaft and are positioned to shift the center of gravity so that the center of gravity is closer to the axis of rotation than the center of gravity would be without the weights in a bowed shaft. These balance weights are adjustable and moved to one position when the turbomachine is shutdown (or starting up) to counteract the bowing of the shaft, and another position when the turbomachine is operating normally, so as not to introduce imbalance into an operating shaft. In some embodiments, the movement of the weights between the operating position and shutdown position is active, and

the balance weights are moved by a controller, for example. In other embodiments, the movement of the balance weights is passive and the weights move based on the operating condition of the engine. For example, the weights may move to the operating position by the inertial forces on the weights by rotation of the shaft, and the weights may move to the shutdown position by gravity when the draft is not rotating.

(26) The balance weights discussed herein may be used in any turbomachine, and may be used in any suitable type of gas turbine engine, such as, for example, gas turbine engines used for aircraft, industrial gas turbine engines incorporated into power generation systems, and nautical gas turbine engines.

(27) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an aircraft **10** that may implement various preferred embodiments. The aircraft **10** includes a fuselage **12**, wings **14** attached to the fuselage **12**, and an empennage **16**. The aircraft **10** also includes a propulsion system that produces a propulsive thrust required to propel the aircraft **10** in flight, during taxiing operations, and the like. The propulsion system for the aircraft **10** shown in FIG. 1 includes a pair of engines **100**. In this embodiment, each engine **100** is attached to one of the wings **14** by a pylon **18** in an under-wing configuration. Although the engines **100** are shown attached to the wing **14** in an under-wing configuration in FIG. 1, in other embodiments, the engine **100** may have alternative configurations and be coupled to other portions of the aircraft **10**. For example, the engine **100** may additionally or alternatively include one or more aspects coupled to other parts of the aircraft **10**, such as, for example, the empennage **16**, and the fuselage **12**. Although the aircraft **10** shown in FIG. 1 is an airplane, the embodiments described herein may also be applicable to other aircraft **10**, including, for example, helicopters and unmanned aerial vehicles (UAV).

(28) FIG. 2 is a schematic, cross-sectional view of one of the engines **100** used in the propulsion system for the aircraft **10** shown in FIG. 1. The cross-sectional view of FIG. 2 is taken along line 2-2 in FIG. 1. For the embodiment depicted in FIG. 2, the engine **100** is a high bypass turbofan engine. The engine **100** may also be referred to as a turbofan engine **100** herein. The turbofan engine **100** has an axial direction A (extending parallel to a longitudinal centerline **101**, shown for reference in FIG. 2), a radial direction R, and a circumferential direction. The circumferential direction C (see FIG. 4) extends in a direction rotating about the axial direction A. The turbofan engine **100** includes a fan section **102** and a turbomachine **104** disposed downstream from the fan section **102**.

(29) The turbomachine **104** depicted in FIG. 2 includes a tubular outer casing **106** (also referred to as a housing or a nacelle) that defines an inlet **142**. In this embodiment, the inlet **142** is annular. The outer casing **106** encases an engine core that includes, in a serial flow relationship, a compressor section **110** including a booster or a low-pressure (LP) compressor **112** and a high-pressure (HP) compressor **114**, a combustion section **120**, a turbine section **130** including a high-pressure (HP) turbine **132** and a low-pressure (LP) turbine **134**, and a jet exhaust nozzle section **144**. The compressor section **110**, the combustion section **120**, and the turbine section **130** together define at least in part a core air flow path **140** extending from the inlet **142** to the jet exhaust nozzle section **144**.

(30) Each of the LP compressor **112** and the HP compressor **114** may include a plurality of compressor rotors **116**. The compressor rotors **116** are shown schematically in FIG. 2 in the core air flow path **140**, and for clarity, only one compressor rotor **116** is labeled in each of the LP compressor **112** and the HP compressor **114**. The compressor rotor **116** may include a disk **116a** (FIGS. 3 to 5) and a plurality of compressor blades **116b** (FIGS. 3 to 5) radially extending from the disk. Other configurations of the compressor rotor **116** may be used, including, for example, blisks where the disk **116a** and the compressor blades **116b** are integrally formed with each other to be a single piece. Each compressor rotor **116** (or stage) may be used to sequentially compress the air flowing through the core air flow path **140**.

(31) Each of the HP turbine **132** and the LP turbine **134** may include a plurality of turbine rotors

136. The turbine rotors **136** are shown schematically in FIG. 2 as a line in the core air flow path **140**, and for clarity, only one turbine rotor **136** is labeled in each of the HP turbine **132** and the LP turbine **134**. Any suitable configuration for a turbine rotor **136** may be used including, for example, a disk and a plurality of turbine blades extending from the disk. Combustion gases are discharged from a combustion chamber **124** of a combustor **122** of the combustion section **120**, as discussed further below. These combustion gases may be directed by a nozzle into the turbine rotors **136** of the HP turbine **132** and then the turbine rotors **136** of the LP turbine **134**, and the combustion gases drive (rotate) the turbine rotors **136** of the HP turbine **132** and the LP turbine **134**.

(32) The turbofan engine (turbomachine **104**) further includes one or more drive shafts. More specifically, the turbofan engine includes a high-pressure (HP) shaft **118** drivingly connecting the HP turbine **132** to the HP compressor **114**, and a low-pressure (LP) shaft **138** drivingly connecting the LP turbine **134** to the LP compressor **112**. The HP shaft **118** and the LP shaft **138** may also be referred to as spools. More specifically, the turbine rotors **136** of the HP turbine **132** are connected to the HP shaft **118**, and the compressor rotors **116** of the HP compressor **114** are connected to the HP shaft **118**. When the turbine rotors **136** of the HP turbine **132** are rotated by the combustion gases flowing through the core air flow path **140**, the turbine rotors **136** of the HP turbine **132** rotate the compressor rotors **116** of the HP compressor **114** via the HP shaft **118**. Similarly, the turbine rotors **136** of the LP turbine **134** are connected to the LP shaft **138**, and the compressor rotors **116** of the LP compressor **112** are connected to the LP shaft **138**. When the turbine rotors **136** of the LP turbine **134** are rotated by the combustion gases flowing through the core air flow path **140**, the turbine rotors **136** of LP turbine **134** rotate the compressor rotors **116** of the LP compressor **112** via the LP shaft **138**.

(33) Each of the HP shaft **118** and LP shaft **138** may be supported by a plurality of bearings. For example, the HP shaft **118** is supported by a forward bearing **182** and a rear bearing **184**, and the LP shaft **138** is supported by a forward bearing **186** and a rear bearing **188**. Although only two bearings are shown in FIG. 2 for each of the HP shaft **118** and LP shaft **138**, more than two bearings, e.g., three or four bearings, forward and/or aft of the respective illustrated locations, may be arranged to support the HP shaft **118** or the LP shaft **138** at the respective positions, and may be evenly spaced or irregularly spaced depending on the geometry of the bearing supporting structure, and available space and clearances.

(34) The fan section **102** shown in FIG. 2 includes a fan **150** having a plurality of fan blades **152** coupled to a disk **154**. The fan blades **152** and the disk **154** are rotatable, together, about the longitudinal centerline (axis) **101** by the LP shaft **138**. The LP compressor **112** may also be directly driven by the LP shaft **138**, as depicted in FIG. 2. The disk **154** is covered by a rotatable front hub **156** aerodynamically contoured to promote an airflow through the plurality of fan blades **152**. Further, an annular fan casing or an outer nacelle **160** circumferentially surrounds the fan **150** and/or at least a portion of the turbomachine **104**. The nacelle **160** is supported relative to the turbomachine **104** by a plurality of circumferentially spaced outlet guide vanes **158**. A downstream section **162** of the nacelle **160** extends over an outer portion of the turbomachine **104** so as to define a bypass airflow passage **164** therebetween.

(35) The turbofan engine **100** is operable with a fuel system **170** and receives a flow of fuel from the fuel system **170**. The fuel system **170** includes a fuel delivery assembly **173** providing the fuel flow from a fuel tank **171** to the turbofan engine **100**, and, more specifically, to a plurality of fuel nozzles **126** that inject fuel into the combustion chamber **124** of the combustor **122** of the combustion section **120**. The components of the fuel system **170**, and, more specifically, the fuel tank **171**, is an example of a fuel source that provides fuel to the fuel nozzles **126**. The fuel delivery assembly **173** includes tubes, pipes, conduits, and the like, to fluidly connect the various components of the fuel system **170** to the engine **100**. The fuel tank **171** is configured to store the fuel, and the fuel is supplied from the fuel tank **171** to the fuel delivery assembly **173**. The fuel delivery assembly **173** is configured to carry the fuel between the fuel tank **171** and the engine **100**.

and, thus, provides a flow path (fluid pathway) of the fuel from the fuel tank **171** to the engine **100**.
(36) The fuel system **170** includes at least one fuel pump fluidly connected to the fuel delivery assembly **173** to induce the flow of the fuel through the fuel delivery assembly **173** to the engine **100**. One such pump is a main fuel pump **175**. The main fuel pump **175** is a high-pressure pump that is the primary source of pressure rise in the fuel delivery assembly **173** between the fuel tank **171** and the engine **100**. The main fuel pump **175** may be configured to increase a pressure in the fuel delivery assembly **173** to a pressure greater than a pressure within the combustion chamber **124** of the combustor **122**.

(37) The fuel system **170** also includes a fuel metering unit **177** in fluid communication with the fuel delivery assembly **173**. Any suitable fuel metering unit **177** may be used including, for example, a metering valve. The fuel metering unit **177** is positioned downstream of the main fuel pump **175** and upstream of a fuel manifold **128** and configured to distribute fuel to the fuel nozzles **126**. The fuel system **170** is configured to provide the fuel to the fuel metering unit **177**, and the fuel metering unit **177** is configured to receive fuel from the fuel tank **171**. The fuel metering unit **177** is further configured to provide a flow of fuel to the engine **100** in a desired manner. More specifically, the fuel metering unit **177** is configured to meter the fuel and to provide a desired volume of fuel, at, for example, a desired flow rate, to the fuel manifold **128** of the engine **100**. The fuel manifold **128** is fluidly connected to the fuel nozzles **126** and distributes (provides) the fuel received to the plurality of fuel nozzles **126**, where the fuel is injected into the combustion chamber **124** of the combustor **122**, mixed with compressed air from the compressor section **110** to form a fuel and air mixture, and combusted, generating combustion products (combustion gases). Adjusting the fuel metering unit **177** changes the volume of fuel provided to the combustion chamber **124** and, thus, changes the amount of propulsive thrust produced by the engine **100** to propel the aircraft **10**.

(38) The engine **100** may also include an engine controller **190**. The engine controller **190** is configured to operate various aspects of the engine **100**, including, in some embodiments, the bow mitigation systems **200**, **202**, and **204** (see FIGS. **3**, **8**, and **9**), discussed herein. In this embodiment, the engine controller **190** is a computing device having one or more processors **192** and one or more memories **194**. The processor **192** can be any suitable processing device, including, but not limited to, a microprocessor, a microcontroller, an integrated circuit, a logic device, a programmable logic controller (PLC), an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), and/or a Field Programmable Gate Array (FPGA). The memory **194** can include one or more computer-readable media, including, but not limited to, non-transitory computer-readable media, a computer-readable non-volatile medium (e.g., a flash memory), a RAM, a ROM, hard drives, flash drives, and/or other memory devices.

(39) The memory **194** can store information accessible by the processor **192**, including computer-readable instructions that can be executed by the processor **192**. The instructions can be any set of instructions or a sequence of instructions that, when executed by the processor **192**, causes the processor **192** and the engine controller **190** to perform operations. In some embodiments, the instructions can be executed by the processor **192** to cause the processor **192** to complete any of the operations and functions for which the engine controller **190** is configured, as will be described further below. The instructions can be software written in any suitable programming language, or can be implemented in hardware. Additionally, and/or alternatively, the instructions can be executed in logically and/or virtually separate threads on the processor **192**. The memory **194** can further store data that can be accessed by the processor **192**.

(40) The technology discussed herein makes reference to computer-based systems and actions taken by, and information sent to and from, computer-based systems. One of ordinary skill in the art will recognize that the inherent flexibility of computer-based systems allows for a great variety of possible configurations, combinations, and divisions of tasks and functionality between components and among components. For instance, processes discussed herein can be implemented

using a single computing device or multiple computing devices working in combination. Databases, memory, instructions, and applications can be implemented on a single system or distributed across multiple systems. Distributed components can operate sequentially or in parallel.

(41) The turbofan engine **100** discussed herein is, of course, provided by way of example only. In other embodiments, any other suitable engine may be utilized with aspects of the present disclosure. For example, in other embodiments, the engine may be any other suitable gas turbine engine, such as a turboshaft engine, a turboprop engine, a turbojet engine, an unducted single fan engine, and the like. In such a manner, in other embodiments, the gas turbine engine may have other suitable configurations, such as other suitable numbers or arrangements of shafts, compressors, turbines, fans, etc. Further, although the turbofan engine **100** is shown as a direct drive, fixed-pitch turbofan engine **100**, in other embodiments, a gas turbine engine may be a geared gas turbine engine (i.e., including a gearbox between the fan **150** and a shaft driving the fan, such as the LP shaft **138**), may be a variable pitch gas turbine engine (i.e., including a fan **150** having a plurality of fan blades **152** rotatable about their respective pitch axes), etc. Further, still, in alternative embodiments, aspects of the present disclosure may be incorporated into, or otherwise utilized with, any other type of engine, such as reciprocating engines. Additionally, in still other exemplary embodiments, the exemplary turbofan engine **100** may include or be operably connected to any other suitable accessory systems.

(42) FIG. **3** is a schematic, detail cross-sectional view of the HP shaft **118**, showing detail **3** in FIG. **2**. Some details of the turbomachine **104** are omitted for clarity. When the turbofan engine **100** (FIG. **2**) is shut down after operating for a period of time, the components of the turbofan engine **100** begin to cool. The HP shaft **118** also begins to cool, but the HP shaft **118** may not cool down evenly. Uneven cooling of the rotor may result in a top portion of the HP shaft **118** being longer than a bottom portion of the shaft. The HP shaft **118** is supported by the forward bearing **182** at a forward portion of the HP shaft **118**, and the HP shaft **118** is supported by the rear bearing **184** at a rear portion of the HP shaft **118**. With the HP shaft **118** being supported (constrained) by the forward bearing **182** and the rear bearing **184**, the length difference from uneven cooling creates a bow in the HP shaft **118**. As illustrated in FIG. **3**, a centerline **119** of the HP shaft **118** is bowed upward relative to a rotational axis **118a** of the HP shaft **118**. In this embodiment, the rotational axis **118a** is coincident with the longitudinal centerline **101** of the turbofan engine **100**.

(43) The HP shaft **118** includes a center of gravity CG (see FIG. **5**). Preferably, the center of gravity CG of the HP shaft **118** is located on the centerline **119** of the HP shaft **118** such that, during normal operation when the centerline **119** is aligned with the rotational axis **118a**, the rotational axis **118a** passes through the center of gravity CG of the HP shaft **118**. This condition provides for balanced rotation and prevents vibration. Bowing of the HP shaft **118** causes the center of gravity CG of the HP shaft **118** to move off of the rotational axis **118a** of the shaft, as schematically indicated by the bowed center of gravity CGB. If rotated under such conditions, the bowed HP shaft **118** causes vibration. As noted above and as will be discussed further below, some amount of vibration may be acceptable when the turbofan engine **100** and, more specifically, the HP shaft **118** are started (rotated), but greater amounts of bowing result in a greater shift of the bowed center of gravity CGB from the rotational axis **118a** and results in vibrations that are not acceptable if the HP shaft **118** is operated (rotated) in the bowed condition. To mitigate this bowed center of gravity CGB relative to the rotational axis **118a**, the HP shaft **118** includes a bow mitigation system **200**. The bow mitigation system **200** moves the center of gravity (a mitigated center of gravity CGM) in a direction opposite to the bow. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **3**, the bow mitigation system **200** moves the center of gravity of the HP shaft **118** from the bowed center of gravity CGB downward to the mitigated center of gravity CGM, and the mitigated center of gravity CGM is closer to the rotational axis **118a** than the bowed center of gravity CGB. This movement of the center of gravity off of the centerline **119** of the HP shaft **118** is referred to herein as the static imbalance of the HP shaft **118**.

(44) The bow mitigation system **200** of this embodiment is shown in FIGS. 3 to 5. FIGS. 4 and 5 are cross-sectional views of the HP shaft **118**, taken along line 4-4 in FIG. 3. FIG. 4 shows the HP shaft **118** and the bow mitigation system **200** in a shutdown condition, and FIG. 5 shows the HP shaft **118** and the bow mitigation system **200** in an operating condition. The bow mitigation system **200** of this embodiment includes a plurality of adjustable balance weight assemblies **210**. The adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** are arrayed circumferentially around the HP shaft **118** and connected to this HP shaft **118** in this arrangement. The adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** are located axially (in the axial direction of the HP shaft **118**) between the forward bearing **182** and the rear bearing **184**. In this embodiment, the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** are located within the compressor section **110** (FIG. 2), and more specifically, within the HP compressor **114**. As noted above, each compressor rotor **116** includes a disk **116a** and a plurality of compressor blades **116b**. The adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** are attached to the disk **116a** of one of the compressor rotors **116** of the HP compressor **114** in this embodiment and, thereby, connected to the HP shaft **118**. The adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** may be attached to the disk **116a** in any suitable manner. In this embodiment, each adjustable balance weight assembly **210** is directly attached to the disk **116a** in a manner similar to the way a vortex tube is attached to the disk **116a**.

(45) Each adjustable balance weight assembly **210** includes a movable balance weight **212** that is movable to change the center of gravity from the bowed center of gravity CGB to the mitigated center of gravity CG.sub.M as discussed above. The movable balance weight **212** may be movable between a first position and a second position to change the center of gravity CG of the HP shaft **118**. In this embodiment, each adjustable balance weight assembly **210** includes a plurality of chambers. Each adjustable balance weight assembly **210** may include a first chamber and at least one at least one additional chamber. In this embodiment, one chamber is an inner chamber **214** and the other chamber is an outer chamber **216**. The outer chamber **216** is positioned radially outward of the inner chamber **214**. In this embodiment, the movable balance weight **212** is a flowable mass and the inner chamber **214** is fluidly connected to the outer chamber **216** by a flow passage **218** to allow the flowable mass to flow between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216**. The flowable mass may be a powder comprising a plurality of particles. Examples of suitable powders include metal particles and sand. The flowable mass alternatively may be a liquid, such as mercury, for example. The flowable mass alternatively may be a semi-solid viscous mass, such as shear thickening fluid, silicone grease, or aero gel, for example. The flowable mass may be any combination of these examples, such as, for example the plurality of particles suspended within a liquid. Each adjustable balance weight assembly **210** has an hourglass shape with a radially inner portion of the inner chamber **214** being wider than a radially outer portion of the inner chamber **214**, and a radially outer portion of the outer chamber **216** being wider than a radially inner portion of the outer chamber **216**. The outer portion of the inner chamber **214** is connected to the inner portion of the outer chamber **216** by the flow passage **218**. The flow passage **218** is the narrowest portion of the adjustable balance weight assembly **210**, in this embodiment, and limits (regulates) the flow of the movable balance weight **212** (flowable mass) between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216**.

(46) FIG. 4 shows the bow mitigation system **200** in a shutdown condition. In this embodiment, movement of the movable balance weight **212** between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216** is passive. There are no valves, motors, pumps, or other active system to move the movable balance weight **212**. Instead, positioning of the movable balance weight **212**, which is a flowable mass in this embodiment, between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216** is driven by gravity in the shutdown condition, when bowing of the HP shaft **118** may occur. When the HP shaft **118** is shutdown, the HP shaft **118** does not rotate, and the movable balance weights **212** in the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** located on a top portion of the HP shaft **118** (above the longitudinal centerline **101**) flow downward through the flow passage **218** from the

outer chamber **216** to the inner chamber **214**. This downward flow of the movable balance weight **212** is movement (positioning) of the movable balance weight **212** in a radially inward direction. (47) To the extent the movable balance weight **212** is not already positioned in the outer chamber **216**, the movable balance weights **212** in the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** located on a bottom portion of the HP shaft **118** (below the longitudinal centerline **101**) also flow downward through the flow passage **218**, flowing from the inner chamber **214** to the outer chamber **216**. This downward flow of the movable balance weight **212** is movement (positioning) of the movable balance weight **212** in a radially outward direction. The center of gravity of the HP shaft **118** moves downward from the bowed center of gravity CG.sub.B to the mitigated center of gravity CG.sub.M with the radially inward movement of the movable balance weight **212** for the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** located on the top portion of the HP shaft **118** and the radially outward movement of the movable balance weight **212** for the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** located on the bottom portion of the HP shaft **118**. The bow mitigation system **200** of this embodiment positions the movable balance weight **212** of the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** located on the top portion of the HP shaft **118** radially inward and positions the movable balance weight **212** of the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** located on the bottom portion of the HP shaft **118** radially outward in the shutdown condition, producing the static imbalance of the HP shaft **118**.

(48) FIG. 5 shows the bow mitigation system **200** in an operating condition. In operation, the bow mitigation system **200** positions the movable balance weight **212** of each adjustable balance weight assembly **210** at a position to locate the center of gravity CG on the centerline **119** of the HP shaft **118**. As noted above, the movement of the movable balance weight **212** between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216** is passive in this embodiment. During startup or while operating, the HP shaft **118** and the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** rotate. When the HP shaft **118** and the adjustable balance weight assemblies **210** rotate, inertial forces act on the movable balance weight **212** (flowable mass) causing the movable balance weight **212** to flow radially outward, and, thus, to the extent the movable balance weight **212** is located in the inner chamber **214**, the movable balance weight **212** flows from the inner chamber **214** through the flow passage **218** into the outer chamber **216** and centers the center of gravity CG at the rotational axis **118a** (see FIG. 3). The movable balance weights **212** are, thus, located at a radially outward position when the HP shaft **118** is in an operating condition.

(49) FIG. 6 is a graph showing the magnitude of bowing in the HP shaft **118** as a function of motoring time. As discussed above, to restart the turbomachine **104** with an HP shaft **118** that is thermally bowed, the turbomachine **104** is motored for a period of time, referred to herein as motoring time. The y-axis is the magnitude of bowing in the HP shaft **118**, and the x-axis is the amount of time that the turbomachine **104** has been motored. An HP shaft **118** without the bow mitigation system **200** is shown by the upper line (dash-dot line labeled thermal bow in FIG. 6). The magnitude of bow in the HP shaft **118** is the greatest at time zero and decreases as the HP shaft **118** is motored (motoring time). In the illustration shown in FIG. 6, the unmitigated HP shaft **118** needs to be motored for at least approximately forty-seven minutes before the amount of bow in the HP shaft **118** is reduced to a level that is acceptable, which is a level that is below the acceptable bow line (indicated by the horizontal broken line). The static imbalance of the HP shaft **118** or the center of gravity shift (CG shift) produced by the bow mitigation system **200** can be estimated as a negative bow as shown by the bottom line (dash-long dash line labeled CG shift in FIG. 6). Summing the thermal bow line with the CG shift line results in the net bow line indicated by the solid line in FIG. 6. The net bow line (mitigated bow) produced by the bow mitigation system **200** results in the net bow crossing the acceptable bow line between twenty and thirty minutes. In this example, the effect of the bow mitigation system **200** reduces the motoring time by about twenty minutes.

(50) FIG. 7 shows a bow mitigation system **202** according to another embodiment. The bow

mitigation system **202** is similar to the bow mitigation system **200** discussed above, and the discussion of the bow mitigation system **200** above applies to the bow mitigation system **202** of this embodiment. The same reference numerals of the bow mitigation system **200** discussed above will be used to refer to the same or similar components in this embodiment and a detailed description of these components is omitted here.

(51) In this embodiment, the movement of the movable balance weight **212** between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216** is active. The adjustable balance weight assembly **210** includes a valve **222** located between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216** to control the movement (flow) of the movable balance weight **212**, which is also a flowable mass in this embodiment. The valve **222** may be positioned in the flow passage **218** to control the flow of the flowable mass through the flow passage **218**. The valve **222** may include a closed position and at least one open position. In some embodiments, the valve **222** includes a plurality of open positions. In the open positions, the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216** are fluidly connected to each other so that the flowable mass can flow through the flow passage **218** between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216**. When the valve **222** includes a plurality of open positions, the valve **222** controls the size of the fluid connection between the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216** to control the rate of flow through the flow passage **218**. In the closed position the valve **222** isolates (fluidly disconnects) the inner chamber **214** and the outer chamber **216** from each other.

(52) Any suitable valve **222** may be used including a programmable logic control valve. The valve **222** is communicatively coupled to a controller **224**, which, in this embodiment, is the engine controller **190** (FIG. 2). The controller **224** may, however, be a standalone controller or other suitable controller of the turbofan engine **100** (FIG. 2) or aircraft **10** (FIG. 1). The controller **224** may be communicatively coupled to the valve **222** by any suitable connection, including wired connections or wireless connections using a corresponding communication protocol. Here, when the valve **222** is located on the rotating components of the turbomachine **104** (FIG. 2), the valve **222** and the controller **224** are preferably connected by a wireless connection using Bluetooth®, Wi-Fi®, or other short range wireless protocol. The valve **222** and the controller **224** may thus each include a transmitter and a receiver to wirelessly communicate with each other. The controller **224** is configured to operate the valve **222** and to control the movement (flow) of the movable balance weight **212**.

(53) The controller **224** is configured to receive inputs indicating the bow of the HP shaft **118** (FIG. 2) and/or the position of the movable balance weight **212**. The controller **224** may be communicatively coupled to sensors **226** that provide these inputs. The controller **224** may be directly, communicatively, coupled to the sensors **226**. The controller **224** may also be indirectly coupled to such sensors **226** and receive inputs from another source, such as a flight controller for the aircraft **10** (FIG. 1). Such sensors **226** may include, for example, accelerometers and clearance probes mounted on the adjustable balance weight assembly **210** or other portions of the turbomachine **104** (FIG. 2) to determine the bow direction and the magnitude of the HP shaft **118** and the static imbalance produced by the bow mitigation system **202**.

(54) FIG. 8 is a flow chart showing operation of the bow mitigation system **202** of FIG. 7. In step **S805**, the controller **224** determines the time after the HP shaft **118** (FIG. 2) has stopped rotating after an operating condition (time after shutdown). The controller **224** may determine the time after shutdown by receiving an input of this value or operating a clock (timer) after counting the time after executing a shutdown operation. The controller **224** also may monitor the temperature of the HP shaft **118** and/or other suitable temperature that is indicative of the bow of the HP shaft **118** in Step **S805**. A temperature sensor may be one of the sensors **226** communicatively coupled to the controller **224** to provide this temperature. In step **S810**, the controller **224** determines the bow direction and/or magnitude of the bow of the HP shaft **118**. When equipped with sensors **226** to monitor the bow of the HP shaft **118**, the controller may use inputs from these sensors **226** to

determine the bow direction and the magnitude. Alternatively, or additionally, the controller 224 may calculate the bow direction and the magnitude based on the time after shutdown and the temperature monitored in step S805. In step S815, the controller 224 calculates the amount of bow correction (static imbalance) needed to facilitate start-up based on the bow direction and the magnitude determined in step S810. If the controller 224 has previously positioned the movable balance weight 212, the controller 224 may take into account any existing static imbalance in calculating the amount of bow correction needed in step S815. In step S820, the controller 224 moves the movable balance weight 212 to generate the desired static imbalance, such as by operating the valve 222 to allow an appropriate amount of the flowable mass (movable balance weight 212) to move from the outer chamber 216 to the inner chamber 214 in the adjustable balance weight assembly 210 located on the top portion of the HP shaft 118. Any one or all of steps S810 to S820 may be performed at start-up.

(55) The process shown in FIG. 8 also may include a feedback loop. After step S820, the process may return to step S815 to verify the desired amount of static imbalance has been achieved. If the controller 224 determines additional adjustments are necessary in step S815, the process returns to step S820 to reposition the movable balance weight 212.

(56) FIGS. 9 to 12 show a bow mitigation system 204 according to another embodiment. The bow mitigation system 204 of this embodiment is similar to the bow mitigation system 200 discussed above, and the discussion of the bow mitigation system 200 above applies to the bow mitigation system 204 of this embodiment. The same reference numerals of the bow mitigation system 200 discussed above will be used to refer to the same or similar components in this embodiment and a detailed description of these components is omitted here. The movable balance weight 212 of this embodiment is also a flowable mass as in the embodiments discussed above.

(57) FIG. 9 is a schematic cross-sectional view of the HP shaft 118. FIG. 9 is a similar perspective as FIG. 3 that shows detail 3 in FIG. 2, but FIG. 9 shows the bow mitigation system 204 of this embodiment. FIGS. 10 and 11 are cross-sectional views of the HP shaft 118, taken along line 10-10 in FIG. 9. FIG. 10 shows the HP shaft 118 and the bow mitigation system 204 in a shutdown condition, and FIG. 11 shows the HP shaft 118 and the bow mitigation system 204 in an operating condition. Referring to FIGS. 9 to 11, the bow mitigation system 204 of this embodiment includes an annular housing 230 that is divided into a plurality of chambers 232. The annular housing 230 may be a balance weight assembly, and the plurality of chambers of the annular housing 230 may include a first chamber and at least one additional chamber. As with the adjustable balance weight assembly 210 discussed above, the housing 230 is attached to the HP shaft 118. The chambers 232 are arranged in the circumferential direction C of the housing 230 and the HP shaft 118, and are separated from each other by a baffle 234. The housing 230, thus, also includes a plurality of baffles 234 arranged in the circumferential direction C of the housing 230 and HP shaft 118.

(58) FIG. 12 shows the baffle 234. In this embodiment, the baffle 234 is a plate having a plurality of orifices 236 formed therein. The orifices 236 shown in FIG. 12 are ovular, but the orifices 236 may have any suitable shape. The orifices 236 are flow passages, similar to the flow passage 218 discussed above with regard to FIGS. 3 to 5 and 7, that fluidly connect adjacent chambers 232. The baffle 234 and, more specifically, the orifices 236 control the flow (rate of flow) of the movable balance weight 212 between adjacent chambers 232.

(59) Returning to FIG. 11, in operation, the bow mitigation system 204 positions the movable balance weight 212 within the housing 230, and, more specifically, within the chambers 232 to locate the center of gravity CG on the rotational axis 118a. The HP shaft 118 rotates when the turbomachine 104 is operating. The housing 230 rotates with the HP shaft 118, and, as in the embodiment discussed above, inertial forces act on the movable balance weight 212 (flowable mass) causing the movable balance weight 212 to flow radially outward along an outer circumferential surface 238 of the housing 230. As shown in FIG. 11, the movable balance weight 212 may be evenly distributed along the outer circumferential surface 238 to locate the center of

gravity CG on the rotational axis **118a**.

(60) FIG. **10** shows the bow mitigation system **204** in the shutdown condition. When the turbomachine **104** is shut down, the HP shaft **118** stops rotating, and the movable balance weight **212**, which is a flowable mass in this embodiment, is driven by gravity from chambers **232** located in a top portion of the housing **230** (the top portion of the HP shaft **118**) to chambers **232** that are located in a bottom portion of the housing **230** (the bottom portion of the HP shaft **118**). This movement and positioning of the movable balance weight **212** produces the static imbalance, discussed above, to compensate for the bow of the HP shaft **118**.

(61) In this embodiment, the bow mitigation system **204** is passive. If desired, active controls to move the movable balance weight **212** may also be used in a manner similar to the bow mitigation system **202** of the embodiment discussed with reference to FIG. **7**, with a controller, like controller **224**, opening and closing the orifices **236** by suitable means, including, for example, valves, like valve **222**, discussed above.

(62) The discussion above used the HP shaft **118** as an example of a shaft in a turbomachine **104** to which the bow mitigation systems **200**, **202**, **204** discussed herein may be applied. These bow mitigation systems **200**, **202**, **204** may be applied to any other suitable shaft in the turbomachine **104** or the turbofan engine **100**, more generally, including, for example, the LP shaft **138**. By implementing these bow mitigation systems **200**, **202**, **204**, the magnitude of the vibration produced by bow may be reduced and the motoring time before start-up of the turbofan engine **100** can be reduced or even eliminated. Further aspects of the present disclosure are provided by the subject matter of the following clauses.

(63) A turbomachine comprises a turbine rotor, a compressor rotor, a shaft, and at least one balance weight assembly connected to the shaft. The turbine rotor is rotatable about a rotational axis. The compressor rotor is rotatable about the rotational axis to compress air flowing past the compressor rotor. The shaft drivingly connects the turbine rotor with the compressor rotor to rotate the compressor rotor about the rotational axis when the turbine rotor rotates about the rotational axis. The at least one balance weight assembly including a first chamber, at least one additional chamber, and a balance weight movable between the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber.

(64) The turbomachine of the preceding clause, further comprising a plurality of compressor rotors forming a compressor section, at least one balance weight assembly connected to the shaft within the compressor section.

(65) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the at least one balance weight assembly is connected to the compressor rotor.

(66) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the compressor rotor includes a disk and a plurality of blades extending from the disk, the at least one balance weight assembly connected to the disk of the compressor rotor.

(67) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the disk and the plurality of blades are formed as a single piece.

(68) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the balance weight is a flowable mass.

(69) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the flowable mass is at least one of (i) a powder comprising a plurality of particles, (ii) a liquid, or (iii) a semi-solid viscous mass.

(70) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber are fluidly connected to each other by a flow passage, the flowable mass being movable between the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber by flowing through the flow passage.

(71) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the first chamber is an inner chamber and the at least one additional chamber is an outer chamber.

(72) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the inner chamber, the outer chamber, and the flow passage are arranged in an hourglass shape.

(73) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the at least one balance weight assembly

further includes a valve positioned in the flow passage and movable between a closed position and at least one open position.

(74) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, further comprising a controller communicatively coupled to the valve of the at least one balance weight assembly to control the position of the valve.

(75) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the controller is wirelessly communicatively coupled to the valve.

(76) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, further comprising a plurality of the at least one balance weight assembly.

(77) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the controller is configured to receive inputs indicating a bow of the shaft and to operate the valves to position the flowable mass within each of the balance weight assemblies.

(78) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the controller is configured to position the flowable mass within each of the balance weight assemblies to move the center of gravity of the shaft in a direction opposite to the direction of bow.

(79) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the plurality of the balance weight assemblies is arrayed circumferentially around the shaft.

(80) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the first chamber of each balance weight assembly is an inner chamber and the at least one additional chamber of each balance weight assembly is an outer chamber.

(81) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the outer chamber is positioned radially outward of the inner chamber.

(82) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, further comprising an annular housing connected to the shaft, the annular housing being divided into a plurality of chambers in a circumferential direction of the shaft, the annular housing being the at least one balance weight assembly, and the plurality of chambers includes the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber.

(83) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein adjacent chambers of the plurality of chambers are fluidly connected to each other.

(84) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein adjacent chambers of the plurality of chambers are separated from each other by a baffle.

(85) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the baffle is a plate having a plurality of orifices fluidly connecting adjacent chambers of the plurality of chambers.

(86) A turbomachine comprises a turbine rotor, a compressor rotor, a shaft, and at least one movable balance weight. The turbine rotor is rotatable about a rotational axis. The compressor rotor is rotatable about the rotational axis to compress air flowing past the compressor rotor. The shaft is drivably connecting the turbine rotor with the compressor rotor to rotate the compressor rotor about the rotational axis when the turbine rotor rotates about the rotational axis. The at least one movable balance weight is movable between a first position and a second position to change the center of gravity of the shaft.

(87) The turbomachine of the preceding clause, further comprising a plurality of the at least one movable balance weight arrayed circumferentially around the shaft.

(88) The turbomachine of any preceding clause, wherein the shaft includes a central axis, and wherein each movable balance weight of the plurality of the at least one movable balance weight is positioned such that the central axis does not run through the center of gravity of the shaft when a portion of the balance weights are positioned in the first position and a portion of the balance weights are positioned in the second position.

(89) A method of balancing a bowed shaft of a turbomachine comprises determining a direction of bow of the shaft and moving at least one balance weight from a first position to a second position to move the center of gravity of the shaft in a direction opposite to the direction of bow.

(90) The method of any preceding clause, further comprising monitoring at least one of a time after shutdown of the turbomachine or a temperature indicative of the bow of the shaft and determining a

magnitude of the bow of the shaft based on the at least one of the time after shutdown or the temperature.

(91) The method of any preceding clause, further comprising determining an amount of bow correction needed to facilitate start-up of the turbomachine based on the bow direction and the magnitude, wherein the at least one balance weight is moved based on the amount of bow correction needed.

(92) Although the foregoing description is directed to the preferred embodiments, other variations and modifications will be apparent to those skilled in the art, and may be made without departing from the spirit or the scope of the disclosure. Moreover, features described in connection with one embodiment may be used in conjunction with other embodiments, even if not explicitly stated above.

Claims

1. A method of balancing a shaft of a turbomachine that is bowed, the method comprising: determining a direction of bow of the shaft; monitoring at least one of a time after shutdown of the turbomachine or a temperature indicative of the bow of the shaft; determining a magnitude of the bow of the shaft based on the at least one of the time after shutdown or the temperature; and moving a balance weight connected to the shaft from a first position to a second position to move the center of gravity of the shaft in a direction opposite to the direction of bow based on the magnitude of bow of the shaft.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the balance weight is part of a balance weight assembly including a first chamber and at least one additional chamber, and wherein moving the balance weight from the first position to the second position includes moving the balance weight from the first chamber to the at least one additional chamber.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the turbomachine includes: a turbine rotor rotatable about a rotational axis; and a compressor rotor rotatable about the rotational axis to compress air flowing past the compressor rotor, the shaft drivably connecting the turbine rotor with the compressor rotor to rotate the compressor rotor about the rotational axis when the turbine rotor rotates about the rotational axis.
4. The method of claim 1, further comprising determining an amount of bow correction needed to facilitate start-up of the turbomachine based on the direction of bow and the magnitude, wherein the balance weight is moved based on the amount of bow correction needed.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the balance weight is a flowable mass.
6. A method of balancing a shaft of a turbomachine that is bowed, the method comprising: determining a direction of bow of the shaft; and moving a balance weight connected to the shaft from a first position to a second position to move the center of gravity of the shaft in a direction opposite to the direction of bow, the balance weight being a flowable mass, wherein the balance weight is part of a balance weight assembly including a first chamber and at least one additional chamber, the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber being fluidly connected to each other by a flow passage, the flowable mass being movable between the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber by flowing through the flow passage, and wherein moving the balance weight from the first position to the second position includes moving the balance weight from the first chamber to the at least one additional chamber.
7. The method of claim 6, wherein the flowable mass is at least one of (i) a powder comprising a plurality of particles, (ii) a liquid, or (iii) a semi-solid viscous mass.
8. The method of claim 6, wherein moving the balance weight between the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber includes operating a valve positioned in the flow passage.
9. The method of claim 6, wherein the first chamber is an inner chamber and the at least one additional chamber is an outer chamber.

10. The method of claim 9, wherein the inner chamber, the outer chamber, and the flow passage are arranged in an hourglass shape.
 11. The method of claim 6, wherein the balance weight assembly is an annular housing connected to the shaft, the annular housing being divided into a plurality of chambers in a circumferential direction of the shaft, the plurality of chambers including the first chamber and the at least one additional chamber.
 12. The method of claim 11, wherein adjacent chambers of the plurality of chambers are separated from each other by a baffle.
 13. The method of claim 12, wherein the baffle is a plate having a plurality of orifices fluidly connecting adjacent chambers of the plurality of chambers.
 14. A method of balancing a shaft of a turbomachine that is bowed, the method comprising: determining a direction of bow of the shaft; monitoring at least one of a time after shutdown of the turbomachine or a temperature indicative of the bow of the shaft; determining a magnitude of the bow of the shaft based on the at least one of the time after shutdown or the temperature; and moving a plurality of balance weights connected to the shaft from a first position to a second position to move the center of gravity of the shaft in a direction opposite to the direction of bow based on the magnitude of bow of the shaft.
 15. The method of claim 14, wherein the plurality of the balance weights is arrayed circumferentially around the shaft.
 16. The method of claim 14, wherein each balance weight of the plurality of the balance weights is part of one balance weight assembly of a plurality of balance weight assemblies, each balance weight assembly including a first chamber and a second chamber, and wherein moving the balance weight from the first position to the second position includes moving the balance weight from the first chamber to the second chamber.
 17. The method of claim 16, wherein the plurality of balance weight assemblies is arrayed circumferentially around the shaft, and wherein the first chamber of each balance weight assembly is an inner chamber and the second chamber of each balance weight assembly is an outer chamber.
 18. The method of claim 17, wherein the outer chamber is positioned radially outward of the inner chamber.
 19. The method of claim 16, wherein the balance weight is a flowable mass, and the first chamber and a second chamber are fluidly connected to each other by a flow passage, and wherein moving the balance weight between the first chamber and the second chamber includes operating a valve positioned in the flow passage.
 20. The method of claim 2, wherein the at least one additional chamber is a second chamber, the second chamber being located radially outward of the first chamber.
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